

Tech used in IPL

The whole country seems to be smitten by the IPL bug and what makes it all the more exciting are the review options which can change the game. Use of technology in cricket is not a new thing, however the way it has evolved over the years has made the game more precise and accurate. Let's have a look at some of the most celebrated technologies in cricket and used more recently used in the IPL.

Hawk eye vision: One of the most sophisticated techniques devised in cricket is the Hawk eye vision. It comes into effect to know whether the batsmen is out or not. It's basically a complex computer program which predicts the trajectory of the ball once it leaves the baller's hand. The Hawk eye follows the most predictable way in which the ball goes, this is based on the line, length, wind pressure and the force by which the ball hits the pitch. All of this data is then computed by



Cumulative view of an over from Hawk eye

an algorithm and the decision is given by the umpire based on that. It still isn't the most full proof method but it's as close as it gets to reality.

Snicko: The snicko-meter graphically represents a sound wave which is produced when the ball hits the bat or the batsmen's pad. The snicko which is a tiny device is placed in one of the stumps which essentially is a tiny microphone connected to an oscilloscope. Every time

the ball nicks the bat snicko picks up the noise it creates and displays it to the third umpire to review the decision.

Stump cam: is miniature camera which sits at the edge of the wickets and displays images from pitch length perspective. There is a radio transmitter built in the cam which sends these images to the control room via radio waves.

Wagon wheel: depicts the pattern in which the batsmen has scored runs in all four directions. This pattern is visually represented using colour codes. There is a different colour code for sixes, fours, twos and singles.

Speedo-meter: analyses the speed at which the bowler is throwing his deliveries. Radar gun installed in the direction in which the ball is thrown catch the velocity of the ball and calculates the speed in which it's travelling. This is based on Doppler effect.

Hot spot: This innovative technology makes use of two infra red cameras installed at both ends of the ground and records images continuously. Everytime the bat nicks the ball the Hot Spot creates a prominent white spot on the screen making it easier for the umpire to track the point of impact. This system is still under ICC's review and we might see it's use in the coming years.

I always wondered what is a?

CMS: expands as content management system which essentially is a software that allows you to maintain your content on the web be it images, videos or text. In order to use a CMS you don't require advanced HTML skills or know in-depths of a coding language. Using a CMS you can add and update content at your discretion without involving a designer or paying for one. Famous examples are Drupal, Joomla and DotNetNuke

API: Application programming interface is used to add additional functions to an application. API determines the amount of plug-ins that can be added to the existing system

beta versions: beta is a version of any software or app which is still under developmental phase but is made available to users. This is done in order to find and repair any glitches that might be existing, so that once the final version is out it's as perfect as possible

Blog: blog can be anything from an online diary to a news page which gets updated frequently. It's a common CMS plugin.

Forum: a bulletin board (BB) is more popularly known as a forum. It's a section of a website which accepts text updates from members and often results in building up of a community of sorts. Vbulletin is a popular forum building software.

FTP: File transfer protocol is used to transfer large or multiple files, it's used for uploading web pages or downloading large files.

Database: core of any dynamic site or structured collection of data is known as a database. Data is held in rapidly -accessible format by a database application. Famous example for web servers is MySQL

Internet vs. the Web

You may have often used the term internet or web interchangeably, which may or may not be known to you. However most of us quite often end up using the wrong term at the wrong place. The Web and the internet are two different things and would not work without the other anyway.

The Internet: is a massive of collection of networks, generally speaking it's a networking infrastructure. Millions of computers all over the world are connected via the internet. Any computer can communicate with any other one as long as they both are connected to the internet. This is possible because of a variety of languages known as protocols.

The Web: (World wide web) or web is the medium of accessing information over the internet. Think of it as a information sharing model built on top of the internet. HTTP protocol is a language spoken over the internet to transfer data. HTTP protocol is used by web services to allow applications to communicate with each other. In order to surf the web you have to make use of a browser such as Opera, Firefox or Chrome.